

 	Republic of the Philippines Department of Transportation
	Document No: <u>DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004</u> Rev. No.: <u>001</u> Effective Date: <u>03 August 2022</u>
	RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

INSTRUCTIONS: This form is used in preparing a proposed Re-entry Action Plan in applying to a Scholarship Program. Duly accomplished and signed forms will be submitted to the HRD Division along with the other documentary requirements.

Title of Scholarship Program:	JDS 23 rd Batch Scholarship Program
Name of the Development Partner	Japan International Cooperation Center (JICE) through the National Economic Development Authority (NEDA)

I. REAP BACKGROUND AND INFORMATION	
a. REAP Title	<i>The title should give the reader a good idea of the nature of the REAP.</i> Recommendation and Implementation of Road Safety as Economic Benefit to Rail Projects
b. REAP Objective	<i>The objective must be SMART (Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Result-oriented/Relevant, and Time-bound)</i> To have the DOTr, and subsequently NEDA, adopt a standard methodology, intended to be developed during the program, in considering Road Safety as Economic Benefit to Rail Projects during investment evaluation within 15 months upon completion of the scholarship program.
c. Problem/Opportunity	<i>What issue or opportunity does your REAP hope to address in the Host Organization?</i> <i>Cite concrete examples, cases, and/or reports to support your view that this important but not urgent problem or opportunity exists.</i> (500 words) The Department of Transportation's (DOTr) ongoing major rail projects, such as the Metro Manila Subway Project (MMSP), North-South Commuter Railway (NSCR), and MRT-4, were evaluated and approved by the National Economic and Development Authority (NEDA). A key part of NEDA's approval process is determining the economic viability of these projects, primarily by calculating their Economic Internal Rate of Return (EIRR). For these projects, NEDA assessed economic benefits using standard metrics: savings on Vehicle Operating Costs (VOC), Travel Time Savings (TTS), and CO2 emissions reduction. However, these evaluations did not consider the potential economic benefits of improved road safety, specifically the savings from avoided road accidents. Currently, the DOTr is conducting feasibility studies for several new rail

	projects. These studies internally evaluate a project's viability before submitting it to NEDA for investment evaluation. Preliminary results suggest that relying solely on VOC, TTS, and CO2 reduction as economic benefits often results in EIRRs that barely meet the required threshold of 10%, the benchmark for project viability. To address this, future evaluations could incorporate road safety as an additional economic benefit. Rail systems naturally reduce road congestion, which lowers accident rates. By quantifying the economic savings from fewer road accidents, such as lower medical expenses, reduced lost productivity, and less property damage, the case for rail investments improve. Globally, many transport agencies now recognize road safety as a significant benefit in infrastructure planning. This includes not just the direct savings from fewer accidents but also the wider economic and societal impacts. Adopting this approach in the Philippines would align local practices with international standards and help DOTr make a more compelling argument for future rail systems. Implementing this would require a clear, standardized methodology to quantify road safety benefits. This involves analyzing accident data, forecasting the impact of reduced traffic congestion, and assigning monetary values to avoided incidents. Incorporating these additional benefits would strengthen the overall economic case for rail projects, potentially attracting greater support and funding. In summary, while current rail projects didn't include road safety benefits in their evaluations, there's a clear opportunity to improve future assessments.
d. Description in relation to the Department i. Organizational Outcome	<i>Determine at least one REAP outcome. How will your REAP help the Host Organization enhance service delivery, policies, systems, or competencies?</i> <i>Please indicate which of the following organizational outcomes will your REAP address:</i> <i>Enhancement of Service Delivery</i> <i>Improvement of Organizational Structure</i> <i>System Development</i> <i>Policy Evaluation and Formulation</i> <i>Building Competencies</i> <i>Others</i> <i>(400 words)</i> Enhancement of Service Delivery. Improving the economic viability of rail projects through the inclusion of road safety benefits would lead to higher approval rates, enabling the implementation of more projects. These additional approvals mean more rail systems addressing urban congestion and road safety concerns, delivering safer, more efficient transport to the public. Policy Evaluation and Formulation. Integrating road safety as an economic benefit would directly improve the economic viability of future rail projects submitted to NEDA for investment evaluation. Projects that currently struggle to meet the required 10% Economic Internal Rate of

 	Republic of the Philippines Department of Transportation
	Document No: <u>DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004</u> Rev. No.: <u>001</u> Effective Date: <u>03 August 2022</u>
	RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

	Return (EIRR) threshold could cross this benchmark with the inclusion of avoided road accident savings. By establishing a standardized methodology, DOTr would ensure that these benefits are consistently factored into evaluations, leading to more compelling project proposals. This enhanced policy framework would increase the success rate of NEDA approvals, accelerating the rollout of critical infrastructure while demonstrating a broader socio-economic impact. Building Competencies. The focus on road safety benefits would necessitate the development of specific technical skills within DOTr, such as analyzing accident data and estimating economic impacts of reduced road traffic. This would involve training personnel in advanced feasibility study methodologies and economic modeling tailored to transport projects. By building competencies in this area, DOTr can better prepare proposals that cover actual unaccounted benefits, particularly for borderline projects. The improved capacity to evaluate and justify economic viability would boost the department's efficiency in securing NEDA approval for future rail systems.
ii. Target Competency Improvement	<i>Which competencies do you expect to gain or improve as a result of your studies? How will your suggested program of study contribute to the development of these competencies? You must articulate the significance of your proposed program of study in providing the competencies required to execute your REAP in a clear and succinct manner.</i> (200 words) Intending to apply for Hitotsubashi University's Master of Public Policy (Public Economics) or Kobe University's Master of Economics, I expect to gain competencies in economic evaluation, policy analysis, and advanced quantitative methods. These skills are vital for incorporating road safety as an economic benefit in rail project assessments. Specifically, I aim to enhance my expertise in cost-benefit analysis, econometrics, and data-driven policy evaluation, which are central to justifying the socio-economic value of rail projects. The curriculum of these programs will develop my understanding of public sector economics and equip me with tools to model the economic impacts of avoided road accidents. Exposure to case studies and Japan's transport policies will provide insights into implementing successful methodologies. With these, I expect to be able to develop and integrate robust economic justifications into DOTr's project evaluations, fostering infrastructure development in the Philippines.

e. Relation to the Government's Development Plan	<i>The REAP targeting the problem or opportunity of the Host Organization is aligned to the goals set in the Philippine Government's Development Plan</i> (200 words) The implementation of this Study outcomes through this REAP aligns with the Department of Transportation's (DOTr) role in the Philippine Development Plan (PDP) by contributing to the plan's goals of infrastructure development, sustainable transportation, and improved public safety. By integrating road safety benefits into economic evaluations, DOTr can better demonstrate the viability of rail projects, accelerating the approval and funding process under the PDP's emphasis on building efficient, safe, and inclusive transport systems. This approach also supports the PDP's targets to reduce road fatalities and improve mobility by encouraging investments in rail systems, which decongest roads and minimize accidents. It aligns with the strategy to incorporate broader socio-economic benefits into infrastructure planning, ensuring resources are allocated to projects with the highest impact. By addressing challenges in economic viability evaluations, DOTr can fulfill its mandate to support national development goals and provide infrastructure that enhances both safety and economic growth.
f. Direct Beneficiary	<i>Who will see immediate advantages from your REAP's implementation? How many target beneficiaries does your REAP have? How will your REAP benefit your intended beneficiaries?</i> (200 words) The immediate beneficiaries will be the DOTr and the NEDA. With the inclusion of road safety benefits in economic evaluations, DOTr can better present economic benefits of future rail projects, increasing their chances of approval. This will also benefit commuters who will enjoy safer, more efficient public transportation, and road users who will face fewer accidents because of reduced congestion given the increase of economically viable rail projects. Other key beneficiaries include local governments, who can improve urban planning, and investors, who will have clearer guidelines for funding transport projects. Public safety will also see improvements, as rail systems help decrease road accidents.
g. Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)	<i>How will the implementation of your REAP help women and other marginalized groups (e.g., IP, PWD, LGBTQ++, etc.)? Provide specific strategies to address the needs of the various groups.</i> (200 words) The inclusion of road safety as an economic benefit in the evaluation of rail projects can help secure increased investment in transportation systems, which would have a positive impact on women, marginalized groups, and vulnerable communities. As rail projects become more viable with the addition of road safety benefits, there will be greater approval from NEDA and investors, leading to more rail systems being developed. This increase in investment can help expand coverage to underserved areas, which are often home to marginalized groups, including Indigenous Peoples (IP), Persons with Disabilities (PWDs), and women.

 	Republic of the Philippines Department of Transportation
	Document No: <u>DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004</u> Rev. No.: <u>001</u> Effective Date: <u>03 August 2022</u>
	RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

	With more rail systems approved and funded, these communities can benefit from safer transit with inclusive design features like accessible stations, safer routes, and priority for areas with higher risk of accidents. Moreover, these groups will face fewer accidents due to reduced road congestion, addressing both economic and physical risks. By prioritizing safety in planning, rail systems can become more accessible and equitable for everyone.
h. Output	<i>What output(s) will your REAP generate? How will these outcomes help achieve the desired organizational outcome?</i> (200 words) Standardized Methodology Development. Develop and formalize a standardized methodology, using or by further refining the outputs of the program study, for calculating road safety benefits, ensuring it covers savings from avoided accidents, reduced medical costs, and lost productivity. This methodology should be aligned with international best practices applied in Philippine context. Training and Capacity Building: Organize training programs for DOTr personnel to equip them with the skills needed to apply the methodology in project submissions. This will ensure that future rail projects are evaluated with road safety as an integral factor. Incorporating Methodology into Feasibility Studies: Revise feasibility study templates for all future rail projects to include standardized methodology on road safety benefits as part of the economic evaluation.
II. REAP TIMELINE AND IMPLEMENTATION	
a. Measurability	<i>How will you monitor the success of your REAP implementation? What are your milestones?</i> Stakeholder Engagement • Conduct of stakeholder workshops, particularly with NEDA and other key government bodies, to secure alignment on the proposed methodology. • Documentation of feedback and incorporation into the methodology within eight months post-program completion. Pilot Application • Successful application of the methodology to at least one ongoing or new rail project proposal within 10 months. • Positive feedback from NEDA on the integration of road safety benefits in the project's economic evaluation. Policy Adoption • Adoption of DOTr of the methodology in its further submissions.

b. Sustainability		<i>What is your plan for ensuring that the REAP's gains are institutionalized and sustained after the program's completion?</i>	
		Capacity Building. Conduct targeted training programs for DOTr personnel to institutionalize skills in economic evaluation, accident data analysis, and advanced feasibility study methodologies. This ensures that the competency to implement the methodology is retained within the organization.	
		Monitoring Mechanism. Periodically assess the outcomes of investment evaluation of rail projects that integrate the methodology, ensuring its continued relevance and effectiveness.	
		Knowledge Transfer. Develop knowledge products such as manuals, guidelines, and training modules to facilitate future orientation for new personnel and ensure sustainability beyond the tenure of the current team.	
c. Predictive Action Steps with Identified Success Indicators			
i. Phase/Stage	ii. Expected Output	iii. Timeline	
1. Internal Validation	Validation of the draft methodology through consultations with relevant DOTr technical units.	1-2 months post-program completion	
2. Pilot Application	Application of the methodology to evaluate at least one proposed rail project.	3-4 months	
3. Stakeholder Engagement	Conduct workshops with NEDA, DPWH, and other stakeholders to present the results of the pilot application. Feedback is gathered to refine the methodology further.	5-6 months	
4. Refinement of Methodology	Adjustments to the methodology based on feedback from stakeholders and pilot results. Finalization of the methodology for operational use.	7-8 months	
5. Institutional Integration	Incorporation of the methodology into DOTr's standard operating procedures for project evaluation through internal memoranda or guidelines.	9-10 months	
6. Capacity Building	Conduct training sessions for DOTr personnel on the use of the methodology, focusing on practical application and economic evaluation techniques.	11-12 months	
7. Monitoring and Reporting	Submission of an initial report evaluating the benefits and outcomes of using the methodology on rail projects, highlighting improved EIRR calculations and potential NEDA approvals.	13-15 months	
d. Target Date to Start	3Q 2027		

 	Republic of the Philippines Department of Transportation
	Document No: <u>DOTr-HRDD-Forms-004</u> Rev. No.: <u>001</u> Effective Date: <u>03 August 2022</u>
	RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

e. Target Date to End	4Q 2028
III. RESOURCES	
<i>Estimate the budget you'll need (in pesos per budget item) to effectively implement your REAP. Include your plan for obtaining the required financial assistance.</i>	
Internal Consultation Expenses: PHP 150 x 10 pax x 3 meetings = PHP 4,500 External Consultation Expenses: PHP 200 x 20 pax x 3 meetings = PHP 12,000 Capacity Building Workshop: PHP 500 x 30 pax = PHP 15,000 ESTIMATED TOTAL: PHP 31,500	
IV. COMMENT(S) AND RECOMMENDATION(S)	
a. Immediate Superior (Mentor)	Same as Head of the Office/Division/Service
b. Head of the Office/Division/Service	
c. Human Resource Development Division	

Prepared by:


MIGUEL MARTIN M. DIZON
 Name of Applicant with signature

Recommended by:

(same as approver below)
TIMOTHY JOHN R. BATAN
 Immediate Supervisor with signature (Mentor)

Approved and noted by:


TIMOTHY JOHN R. BATAN
 Head of the Office/Division/Service with signature